SEO Changelog — Post: Best Restaurants in Destin, FL

URL: https://bikkinibottomboat.com/the-ultimate-guide-to-the-best-restaurants-in-destin-fl/ · **WP ID:** 2210 (post, Gutenberg blocks; featured image 2217) · **Audit date:** 2026-10-25 · **Audit page 17 of 24**
Sources: WordPress content and Rank Math fields (site connector), Semrush US rankings for this URL.

1. Summary

Area	Current state	Priority
Biggest traffic opportunity on the site	The post ranks on page 2 for very large searches: "good restaurants destin" **#14 (9,900/mo)**, "great restaurants destin" #16 (9,900), "destin restaurants" #15 (5,400), "best restaurants in destin fl" #15 (2,400), "destin fl restaurants" #16 (1,900), "dining in destin fl" #20 (1,600), "top restaurants in destin" #13 (1,300), "places to eat in destin" #17 (1,300)... More than 50,000 searches/month combined. Top 5 would mean thousands of visits/month, versus about 120 today.	**High**
Thin for the topic	About 1,000 words covering 14 restaurants; ranking competitors typically list 20–40 with addresses, price ranges and photos. Only Dewey Destin's has an address. No prices, hours, map, cuisine summary or "last updated".	**High**
Wrong / bad outbound links	(1) "Crab Island" links to `originalcrabisland.com` (another business; same issue as page 16). (2) **Marina Café links to Louisiana Lagniappe's website**. (3) The Donut Hole links to a scraper page (`donut-hole-bakery-and-cafe.goto-where.com/#google_vignette`), not the official site.	**High**
Headings	No H2s. 5 H3s wrapped in `<strong>`. Restaurant names are bold text, not headings, so there's no scannable structure.	**High**
Rank Math	SEO title and meta empty. Focus keyword "Best Restaurants Destin, FL".	**High**
Booking funnel	Thousands of tourists read this, but the only links to Bikkini Bottom go to the homepage. The closing CTA says "private... experience" (public tours exist too).	**High**
Misc	"Since our family first settled here in 1978" (owner to confirm, as on the FAQ). 5 empty paragraphs. Crab Island link list (blue inline styles) unrelated to dining.	**Low**

2. Keyword targeting

Keyword	Vol.	Now	Use
destin restaurants	5,400	#15	**Primary**: title, H1, intro

good / great restaurants destin	9,900 / 9,900	#14 / #16	Intro + H2 wording ("great restaurants")
best restaurants in destin fl / florida	2,400 / 1,000	#15 / #17	Title
places to eat in destin / best places to eat in destin fl	1,300 / 1,000	#17 / #20	H2 "Quick Picks"
dining in destin fl / destin dining	1,600 / 140	#20 / #9	Body
destin restaurants local favorites	320	#13	Intro ("local favorites")
where to eat in destin fl / destin florida dinner	210 / 390	#12 / #16	H2 "Dinner"
restaurants on destin harbor / you can boat to (long tail)	—	—	New H2s

3. Rank Math / meta changes

Field	Current	Change to
Post title (H1)	The Ultimate Guide to the Best Restaurants in Destin, FL	**Best Restaurants in Destin, FL: 25 Local Favorites ([Year])**. Use the real final count.
Slug	the-ultimate-guide-to-the-best-restaurants-in-destin-fl	**Keep**. It ranks; don't move it.
SEO title	(empty)	**Best Restaurants in Destin, FL ([Year]): 25 Local Favorites** (55)
Meta description	(empty)	**Where locals eat in Destin: waterfront seafood, harbor dinners, beach bars, sushi, breakfast and spots you can reach by boat. Hand-picked by a Destin boat crew.** (155)
Focus keyword	Best Restaurants Destin, FL	**destin restaurants**; secondary: best restaurants in destin fl, good restaurants destin, places to eat in destin
Category	Blog	**Things to Do in Destin**
Featured image	2217	Keep. Set descriptive alt; use as the OG image.

4. Heading structure (new)

Tag	Heading
H1	Best Restaurants in Destin, FL: 25 Local Favorites ([Year])
H2	Destin Restaurants at a Glance (summary table: name · best for · area · price)
H2	Restaurants You Can Get to by Boat (H3: Dewey Destin's Bayside · [others])

H2	Restaurants on Destin Harbor, Near Our Dock (H3: Harbor Docks · Boshamps · Marina Café · AJ's · Dewey Destin's Harborside…)
H2	Great Restaurants in Destin for Dinner (H3: McGuire's · Louisiana Lagniappe · [add 3–5])
H2	Beachfront Dining in Destin (H3: The Back Porch · The Crab Trap · Pompano Joe's · [add])
H2	Best Breakfast in Destin (H3: The Donut Hole · The Pancakery · [add])
H2	Quick Picks by Craving (sushi, Thai, deli, pizza, kids, late night)
H2	Plan a Perfect Destin Day: Boat Tour + Dinner
H2	Destin Restaurant FAQs (H3 each)

Each restaurant H3 gets a consistent block: 1–2 sentence crew take · **Must-try** · **Address** · **Price** ($–$$$$) · **Good for** (families / groups / date night) · official website link. Use one original photo per section where possible.

5. Content rewrites & additions

H1 Best Restaurants in Destin, FL: 25 Local Favorites ([Year])

We run boat tours on Destin Harbor every day, and the first question guests ask when they step off the boat is "where should we eat?" These are the **Destin restaurants** our crew actually recommends: waterfront seafood shacks, harbor dinners with a view, beach bars and the best breakfast in town. These are local favorites, not tourist traps. *Last updated: [Month Year].*

H2 Destin Restaurants at a Glance

Restaurant	Best for	Area	Price
Dewey Destin's (Bayside)	Boat-up seafood lunch	Calhoun Ave, on the bay	$$
Boshamps	Foodie seafood dinner	Destin Harbor	$$$
McGuire's	Groups, steaks, sushi	Hwy 98	$$–$$$
… (one row per restaurant)			

H2 Restaurants on Destin Harbor, Near Our Dock

Coming off a Crab Island tour or sunset dolphin cruise? These harbor restaurants are a short walk or drive from our dock at 530 Harbor Blvd. [Owner: list confirmed walkable spots, e.g. Harbor Docks next door.]

H2 Plan a Perfect Destin Day: Boat Tour + Dinner

- **Morning:** breakfast at The Donut Hole → 4-hour Crab Island tour ($59.99–$74.99)
- **Afternoon:** late lunch at Dewey Destin's on the bay
- **Evening:** sunset dolphin cruise ($25–$35), then dinner on the harbor
- **Thursday night:** the Destin fireworks cruise ($20–$30) after an early-bird dinner at Marina Café

[Book Your Boat Tour]

H2 Destin Restaurant FAQs

H3 What food is Destin known for?

Fresh Gulf seafood, especially grouper, triggerfish, triple tail, Royal Red shrimp and oysters. Destin calls itself the "World's Luckiest Fishing Village."

H3 Which Destin restaurants can you get to by boat?

Dewey Destin's Bayside on Calhoun Ave is a favorite, and several harbor restaurants have courtesy docks. [verify list]

H3 Do Destin restaurants take reservations in summer?

Many harbor and fine-dining spots do and fill up fast in June–August; seafood shacks are first-come. Call ahead or use the waitlist apps.

H3 Where should we eat after a Crab Island tour?

Stay on the harbor. Our dock is steps from several restaurants, so you can go straight from the boat to dinner.

6. Link fixes & internal linking

Link	Fix
"Crab Island" → originalcrabisland.com	→ **/what-is-crab-island/** (internal)
Marina Café → thelouisianalagniappe.com	→ Marina Café's official site [verify URL]
The Donut Hole → goto-where.com scraper	→ The Donut Hole's official site or Google Maps listing [verify]
All restaurant links	Check each URL still resolves (restaurants change domains). Open in a new tab.
Bikkini Bottom (intro), homepage	Keep, but change the anchor to "Destin boat tours"
New contextual links	Crab Island tour → /crab-island-tours-in-destin-fl/ · sunset dolphin cruise → /destin-sunset-dolphin-cruise/ · Destin fireworks cruise → #fireworks · dolphins → /destin-dolphin-cruise/ · Destin fireworks schedule → page 15 post · bachelorette → /destin-bachelorette-party-boat/ (in "Great for groups") · Destin Elite Transportation spotlight (getting to dinner)
Crab Island guide list	Remove; replace with the "Plan a Perfect Destin Day" section.
Closing CTA	"Book your **Destin boat tour**, public tickets or private charter" → Crab Island page; keep the phone number as a `tel:` link.

7. Technical fixes

Issue	Fix	Priority
Headings	Rebuild with H2 sections and H3 per restaurant (§4); remove `<strong>` from headings; delete 5 empty paragraphs.	**High**
Images	Add original photos (crew meals at Dewey's, harbor at sunset) as WebP, 1024w, with descriptive alts (**"Fried shrimp basket at Dewey Destin's on Choctawhatchee Bay"**). Avoid restaurant-owned photos unless you have permission.	**Medium**
Map	A single Google My Maps embed with all listed restaurants plus the Bikkini Bottom dock (lazy-loaded).	**Medium**
Freshness	Visible "Last updated" + yearly review (closures, new spots). Update the title year.	**Medium**
Table of contents	Rank Math TOC block / Elementor TOC after the intro so readers can jump to sections (this can also earn jump links in results).	**Low**
Schema	BlogPosting (author = crew / owner, dateModified) + **ItemList** of Restaurant items (name, address, servesCuisine, priceRange, url) + FAQPage.	**Medium**
Outreach	Tell each listed restaurant they're featured. Many will share or link back, which earns local backlinks to the whole site.	**Low**

8. Tracking

Item	Setup
Content → booking	The KPI for this post: `internal_tour_click` and `begin_checkout` with `link_location` = restaurants_post. Even a 1% click-through on several thousand visits is meaningful.
Outbound restaurant clicks	`outbound_restaurant_click` with the restaurant name. Useful data to share with restaurants for partnerships or cross-promotion.
Rankings	Track the 10 keywords in §2 weekly; baseline #13–20.
Remarketing	Build a GA4 audience of restaurant-post readers who didn't book, for Meta/Google remarketing with a Crab Island or sunset offer.

9. Changelog (implementation checklist)

#	Change	Where	Status
1	**Fix 3 bad outbound links** (originalcrabisland.com, Marina Café, Donut Hole)	Post	To do (urgent)

2	SEO title, meta, focus keyword; H1 with year and count; category change	Post / Rank Math	To do
3	H2/H3 rebuild; restaurant blocks (address, price, must-try, good for)	Editor	To do
4	Expand to about 25 restaurants; add Harbor (near dock), Boat-access and Breakfast sections; at-a-glance table	Editor	To do
5	"Plan a Perfect Destin Day" with tour links and prices; new CTA	Editor	To do
6	FAQ (4) + TOC + map + original photos + "Last updated"	Editor	To do
7	Crab Island link list removed; 7 contextual internal links added	Editor	To do
8	BlogPosting + ItemList(Restaurant) + FAQPage schema	Rank Math	To do
9	Tracking: tour clicks, outbound restaurant clicks, rank tracking, remarketing audience	GA4 / GTM / Semrush	To do
10	Owner: confirm "1978", restaurants near the dock, boat-accessible list; verify all restaurant URLs	Owner	Waiting

Next page in queue: **Post: Lisa Snuggs Real Estate spotlight** (ID 2225).